its growing power asymmetry vis-à-vis China. In Chapter 4, **Sunniva Engh** identifies three parallel trends in India's relationship with China under the Modi administration: deepening economic and diplomatic co-operation, enduring disagreements concerning their disputed border areas, and a growing strategic rivalry in South Asia and the Indian Ocean Region (SA-IOR). She discusses how India manages this complex mix of cooperation and confrontation in its relationship with China.

The next part of the book addresses India's neighbourhood policy in light of China's rise and increased footprint in India's traditional sphere of influence. **S.D. Muni** analyses the drivers behind Modi's "neighbourhood first" policy, with particular focus on the three cases of Bangladesh, Nepal, and Sri Lanka, and examines if it is driven mainly by China's increased footprint in South Asia, by India's own ambition to engage more deeply with its neighbouring countries, or if the main driver is at the leadership level in terms of Prime Minister Modi's more pro-active foreign policy. Muni finds that even if India's "neighbourhood first" policy at the outset was only partially driven by the Chinese challenge, it is now fully controlled by it, and argues that India is implementing a wide range of policies, from cultural diplomacy to recasting its own cooperative programmes and style of engagement to collaborating with like-minded extra-regional powers, in order to keep its neighbourhood secure from the expanding and assertive Chinese presence. Muni then discusses to what extent India is succeeding in its endeavour. Chapter 6, authored by **John W. Garver**, explores how India manages the rise of China by examining the thickening of Sino–Iranian relations and India's response to this development. Garver argues that competition for cooperation with Iran will be a significant variable as India and China are trying to nudge the South Asia–Indian Ocean Region along their desired trajectories and states that China holds certain advantages vis-à-vis India in this contest. He elaborates in particular on